

Discovery Questionnaire

AI Lead Generation — tec5USA

1. Scope

1.1. First-batch industry — should the engine begin with Chemical only, Oil & Gas only, or both in parallel? Searches begin with Chemical only and Oil & Gas only since they're two separate industries.

1.2. OEM vs direct sales — build both lists from week one, or launch one first and add the second once the first is producing leads? It should be fine to build both lists from week one.

1.3. Geographic scope — United States only, North America, or global? North America and South America

1.4. Hard exclusions — confirm the engine excludes: government RFQs, narcotics-detection accounts, defense bid work. Anything else to add? I don't think there is anything else. This is a good list.

1.5 Competitors: MMR, Ametek, Horiba, Elementale, Thermo Fisher Scientific, Kaiser (Endress+Hauser), Bruker, Metrohm, Tornado, Anton Paar, FOSS, Guided Wave / Process Insights, Yokogawa / Perten-adjacent pressure, Guided Wave, Applied Analytics.

By Industry: [tec5USA_2026_competitor_analysis_rewrite_v2- FINAL 2026 - Copy.docx](#)

2. ICP Basics

2.1. Employee count — minimum count to include a company — 50, 75, or 100? Any upper ceiling? Minimum 50 – 100 count. No upper ceiling.

2.2. Sub-segments inside Chemical and Oil & Gas — specialty chemicals, polymers, petrochemicals, sulfur, coatings & adhesives are confirmed. Anything to add or drop?

Refineries / downstream oil & gas

Fuel blending and terminals

Petrochemical manufacturers

Specialty chemical manufacturers

Polymer and plastics producers

Fine chemical / API manufacturers

Gas processing and industrial gas companies

2.3. Anti-targets — any specific companies or buyer types you do NOT want to see in the list — direct competitors, lab-only spectroscopy users, integrators tied to Kaiser/FOSS/Bruker? **This should be good.** Please add companies that do midstream and downstream. Also, refer to Danielle's competitor analysis file that was shared with you.

3. Seed Data

3.2. Lookalike depth — how many lookalike companies should the engine surface per existing customer — 5, 10, or 20?

A realistic approach would be 3–5 audiences, structured like this:

1. Lookalike from current customers — your highest-value accounts
2. Lookalike from engaged prospects — people who opened emails, attended webinars, downloaded content
3. Lookalike from specific job titles — process engineers, analytical chemists, QA/QC managers, R&D leads
4. Lookalike by industry vertical — pharma, food & beverage, chemical manufacturing, oil & gas (each uses in-process spectroscopy differently)
5. Lookalike from trade show/conference contacts — highly relevant since this market is relationship-driven

3.3. Pipeline exclusions — companies already in your sales pipeline must not appear as new leads. Do you share that list as a tagged ZoomInfo segment, a Google Sheet, or another way? **We don't do any of this because we have a very small number of current customers—these customers are kept in Salesforce. They are Eli Lilly located in _____,**

4. Contacts

4.1. Contact priority order — if the engine can verify only 3 contacts at high confidence, the default order is: (1) Process Engineer / Sr. Process Engineer, (2) Plant Manager / Operations Manager, (3) Engineering Manager. Confirm or reorder. **This should be good—the goal is Director or VP level, COO too.** There are many different titles in various industries. Top 3 is hard to choose since each industry has different Top 3 titles. Can we do a top 10 in all industries?

4.2. Number of contacts per account — minimum and maximum per company. Kevin mentioned 5+ ideally — is 3 the floor and 7 the ceiling, or different? **No ceiling as long as the titles are relevant. 3 is the floor...depending on size of company you could have up to 15 contacts.**

5. Signals

5.1. Top 3 signals to weight heaviest — from this menu, which three should the engine focus on for v1?

- Capacity expansion or new-plant announcements
- Hiring of Process Engineers, PAT Scientists, MSAT, or Quality Engineers
- New product line launches
- CapEx project announcements
- Conference attendee lists (in order: SPIE Photonics West, IFPAC, ATC, CPHI Americas, ChemE, IFT First National, BioProcess). Danielle is sending you a trade show list with info.
- M&A activity in the OEM or integrator space
- FDA continuous-manufacturing or PAT-based filings
- CHIPS Act / battery gigafactory funding announcements

5.2. Trade shows that produce the best leads — from Pittcon, SPIE Photonics West, IFPAC, AIChE, ATC, Semicon West, IFT — which 2 or 3 historically deliver the strongest leads? **We have only been to Photonics, IFPAC and ATC so far. I believe IFPAC and ATC have the most leads. Next up is CPHI Americas. I believe IFT First National produced many leads, but I am unsure of the quality.**

5.3. Anything tested before — have any of these signals been tried by your team or a prior vendor? Anything that produced too much noise, leads too late in the cycle, or wrong contacts? **We've never had an AI agent before, and this is all new marketing and sales campaigns and strategies overall.**

6. Output

6.1. Delivery format — Google Sheet, CSV, ZoomInfo tagged list, or direct push to NetSuite? **We upload an Excel document into HubSpot. We cannot use Google Sheets! Maybe Zoominfo tagged list would be nice to use and look into.**

6.2. Required fields per lead — default: company, website, HQ, sub-segment, employee band, signal trigger, ICP score (0–10), contact name / title / verified email / LinkedIn. Add or remove anything? **Add phone number, city, state, zip code (for geotargeting one day). We do have personas created for ICP score but have not used them yet (please refer to Danielle's shared Personas file).**

6.3. Context per lead — should each lead carry a 2–3 sentence research note (why this account fits, what process they likely run, what spectroscopy use case applies)? **Yes. All relevant info.**

6.4. Delivery cadence — weekly batches, or rolling daily drops? I assume this is in reference to when the leads would drop to us. In that case, I would say weekly is fine. We send one email per week per industry. Each campaign is 14-weeks long with each day a different campaign theme: Tues is Pharma (Email blast and LinkedIn post), Wednesday is Food and Beverage (Email blast and LinkedIn post), and Thursday is Oil and Gas (Email blast and LinkedIn post).

7. References

7.1. Sample qualified lead — can you share one example of a perfectly qualified lead — a real account that was exactly what you wished the system had surfaced? With the contact, the signal that made them ripe, and what the conversation looked like. A Qualified lead would be a company interested in implementing Raman, NIR, and UV/VIS inline process spectroscopy into their factory floor. They would have to have a budget in place for purchase, obvious ROI on implementing inline process spectroscopy (they would be encountering issues with product or quality loss, increasing speed of product manufacturing, automation of process analysis reducing man hours spent on manual sampling). Not every company knows or understands inline process spectroscopy to determine if it's needed either—you don't know what you don't know. However, when they understand that our products save time, money, and revenue, they understand the value.

7.2. Sample disqualified lead — the inverse — one lead that looked good on paper but was wrong, and why. This is tough. We don't know until we engage. Sometimes we won't know until after the sale. Employee buy-in and engagement are crucial.

7.3. ATC 2025 conversion data — of the 9 leads on that sheet (DASTEC, Eastman, Chevron, Koch, Oxy, Enterprise Products, etc.), which converted to pipeline conversations? The pattern tells the engine which lead profiles to lookalike against.

The 9 leads are target companies: Marathon, Valero, Phillips66, Shell, BP, HF Sinclair, FHR, Citgo, Chevron. It's who would be ideal because they are oil and gas companies who could use NIR, UV-Vis, and Raman in their various processes.

As for this year's show, ATC 2026:

- **Booth visitors:** 11 companies (all these were converted into conversations, first level conversations.)
- **Four leads have interest** (do not reach out to the below):
 - 4IR is an integrator that wants to put our Raman and NIR into their portable oil analysis rig.
 - Invista is looking at Raman for Nitriles.
 - RBI Solutions (older contact)
- **SQLs:** 1 SQL Wu Quirong (RC Systems), This company is an integrator/OEM. We have been discussing an online gas analyzer for a steel mill.

